

Joshua Lieberstein

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz (2021–Present)
MA, Linguistics, Expected June 2027
BA, Linguistics *cum laude*, June 2025

Non-Degree Education

Mayan Language Institute, *Advanced K'iche'*, Organized by Tulane University, Summer 2025
CreteLing Summer School, University of Crete, Summer 2026

Awards & Honors

2026-2031 Graduate Research Fellowship (National Science Foundation)
2026 Fulbright Foundation (Semi-Finalist)
2025 Foreign Language Area Studies Fellowship (Summer), Vanderbilt University (\$8500)
2025 The Humanities Institute Fellowship, UC Santa Cruz (\$1000)
2022-2024 Dean's Honors, UC Santa Cruz

Publications

1. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Ambiguity Advantage Effect in Wh-Questions*, Accepted in UGA Working Papers.

Presentations

Talks at conferences

- T1. **Lieberstein, Joshua*** & Elizabeth Wood*. *Are consonant sequences clusters? An acoustic experiment of Chichicastenango K'iche'*, Conference on Indigenous Languages of Latin America (CILLA XI)... Upcoming. Oct. 2026.
- T2. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Reportatives and Quotatives in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Workshop on American Indigenous Languages (WAIL28). May 2026.
- T3. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Cláusulas sin verbo en el k'iche' chichicasteco: un enfoque (no) copulativo* ["Verbless Clauses in Chichicastenango K'iche': A (Non)-Copular Focus"], Guatemalan Scholars Network (GSN). July 2025.

* = Co-first authors

Invited talks

- T4. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verb Stranding Ellipsis: The view from Mayan*, Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle), Stanford. June 2026.
- T5. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Linguistics at Santa Cruz 40 (LASC40), UC Santa Cruz. Apr. 2026.
- T6. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Reportatives and Quotatives in K'iche' (Mayan)*, American Indian Seminar (AIS), UCLA. Apr. 2026.
- T7. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, American Indian Seminar (AIS), UCLA. Sept. 2025.
- T8. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Specific Subjects and the Ergative Extraction Constraint in K'iche'*, American Indian Seminar (AIS): Word Order Fest, UCLA. Sept. 2025.

Other talks

- T9. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Polarity, Ellipsis and Verb-Initial Order in K'iche' (Mayan)*, Syntax and Semantics Circle (S-Circle), UC Santa Cruz. Oct. 2025.
- T10. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verbless Clauses in Mayan K'iche': A Copular Investigation*, Syntax and Semantics Circle (S-Circle), UC Santa Cruz. Feb. 2025.
- T11. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Ambiguity Advantage Effect in Wh-Questions*, Speech and Sentence Processing Lab (s/lab), UC Santa Cruz. Nov. 2024.

Posters

- P1. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *The Syntax of Negation in Chichicastenango K'iche'*, CreteLing 7 Poster Session. July 2026.
- P2. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verbless Clauses in K'iche' (Mayan): A (Non)-Copular Investigation*, Linguistics Undergraduate Research Colloquium, UC Santa Cruz. May 2025.
- P3. **Lieberstein, Joshua.** *Verbless Clauses in K'iche' (Mayan): A (Non)-Copular Investigation*, Celebrating the Humanities, The Humanities Institute @ UC Santa Cruz. May 2025.
- P4. **Lieberstein, Joshua & Matt Wagers.** *Ambiguity Advantage in Wh-Questions*, Human Sentence Processing (HSP38), University of Maryland. Mar. 2025.
- P5. Green, Sophie*, Shaya Karasso* & **Joshua Lieberstein***. *Ambiguity Advantage in Wh-Questions*, Linguistics Undergraduate Research Colloquium, UC Santa Cruz. June 2023.

Research Experience

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| 2024-Present | Fieldwork, Chichicastenango K'iche' (Eastern Mayan) |
| 2022-2024 | Research Assistant, IntERPrET Lab , UC Santa Cruz, (Advisor: Dr. Liv Hoversten) |
| 2022-2023 | Research Assistant, Sentence Processing Lab, UC Santa Cruz, (Advisor: Dr. Stephanie Rich) |

Teaching @ UC Santa Cruz

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026 **LING171: Psycholinguistics 1**
Instructor: *Amanda Rysling*
Winter 2026 **LING53: Semantics 1**
Instructor: *Pranav Anand*
Fall 2025 **LING50: Intro to Linguistics**
Instructor: *Matt Wagers*

Tutor

LING112: Syntax 1
Fall 2024 Instructor: *Roumyana Pancheva*
Winter 2024 Instructor: *Maziar Toosarvandani*
Winter 2023 Instructor: *Ivy Sichel*

Fall 2022 **Independent Writing Tutor**

Academic Service

2024-2026 Linguistics Events Planning Committee, *UC Santa Cruz*
Chair, Transportation Subcommittee
Member, Transportation Subcommittee

2024 **Volunteer/Student**, [INEPAS](#), Quetzaltenango, Guatemala. Spanish Language
School/Social Work

Skills

Languages Spoken: English (native); Spanish (advanced); K'iche' (research)

Technical Skills: $\text{\LaTeX}$, R, Python, PCibex

Last updated: July 28, 2026